



Learning Space

IAS MAINS 2020

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

CASE STUDIES

MODULE - 10

CASE STUDY - 10

Raging stubble burning fires in your district in Western Uttar Pradesh are choking Delhi, exacerbating the pollution there and leading to health emergency. The government of Delhi repeatedly requested the government of Uttar Pradesh to address the issue but to no avail. As the District magistrate, you are aware of the following realities:

1. Subsidies were provided to the farmers to buy Happy Seeders machines for paddy straw management to prevent stubble burning.
2. But the farmers, most of them owners of small land holdings, declined to use them citing the following reasons.
 - a) Operating these machines entails huge diesel costs.
 - b) They are useful only during the harvesting season and hence investing on them is not on their agenda due to their limited financial resources.
3. Fearing protests, the state government did not take any steps to make the farmers stop the burning of their stubble.

As a District Magistrate, what options do you have in dealing with the situation, and which one will you choose? Justify your choice with suitable arguments. (250 words)

CASE STUDIES

The case narrates the current environment turmoil in Delhi and lack of proactive role by the surrounding states to solve the crisis.

ETHICAL ISSUES INVOLVED

Farmers' livelihoods
(higher costs in using
machines)

VS

increasing pollution
levels (fundamental
duty to protect
environment)

Need for proactive
governance
(as government took no
steps fearing protests)

VS

abiding to
Government's stand

STAKEHOLDERS

State

Farmers

People in UP and
surrounding states

CASE STUDIES

As a district magistrate, I have following options:

OPTION 1

Ensure strict prevention of stubble burning by controlling dissenting and deviating farmers with punitive measures

MERITS

- Stubble burning is controlled
- Delhi's concern is addressed

DEMERITS

- May result in farmer protests and consequently leading to my transfer by the State government
- Not a long-term solution
- Farmers' livelihood may be affected

OPTION 2

Leave it to Government's discretion without taking any action

MERITS

- No farmers' protests
- No pressure from state government
- My position as magistrate is secured

DEMERITS

- Pollution may further choke our own people
- Delhi's concern is not addressed. People of Delhi may become fractious
- Larger public safety is at stake
- Failed in performing fundamental duty

CASE STUDIES

OPTION 3

- Discuss with local farmers to form groups to pool in money to maintain the machines. The machine can be used by each one in rounds
- As landholdings are mostly small and labour is available because of huge population and unemployment, paddy harvest with hands can be made – manual harvesting leaves little or no residue
- Ensure processing of remaining residue to make it fodder for cattle
- Set up special vigilance cells to check stubble burning
- Empower tehsildars to impose reasonable fines – in accordance with NGT guidelines for banning crop burning.

LONG-TERM MEASURES

- Regular monitoring of farm fires using satellite data and taking timely action
- Alternative methods for farmers to deal with stubble
 - ✓ Beds for animals during winter
- Setup grievance redressal department specific to stubble burning for immediate resolution

CONCLUSION

At utilitarian ethics states, the action that results in greatest good to greatest number of people to largest amount of time is a just action. If environmental concerns are not addressed immediately, they result in disastrous long-term consequences.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0866 244 44 72

98499 42299

94415 27588